

Containers first, files next:

**A layered path to Copilot readiness in
Microsoft 365**

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Monday.
8:47 a.m.

A CFO opens Copilot.



“

Summarise our Q3
margin pressure.”

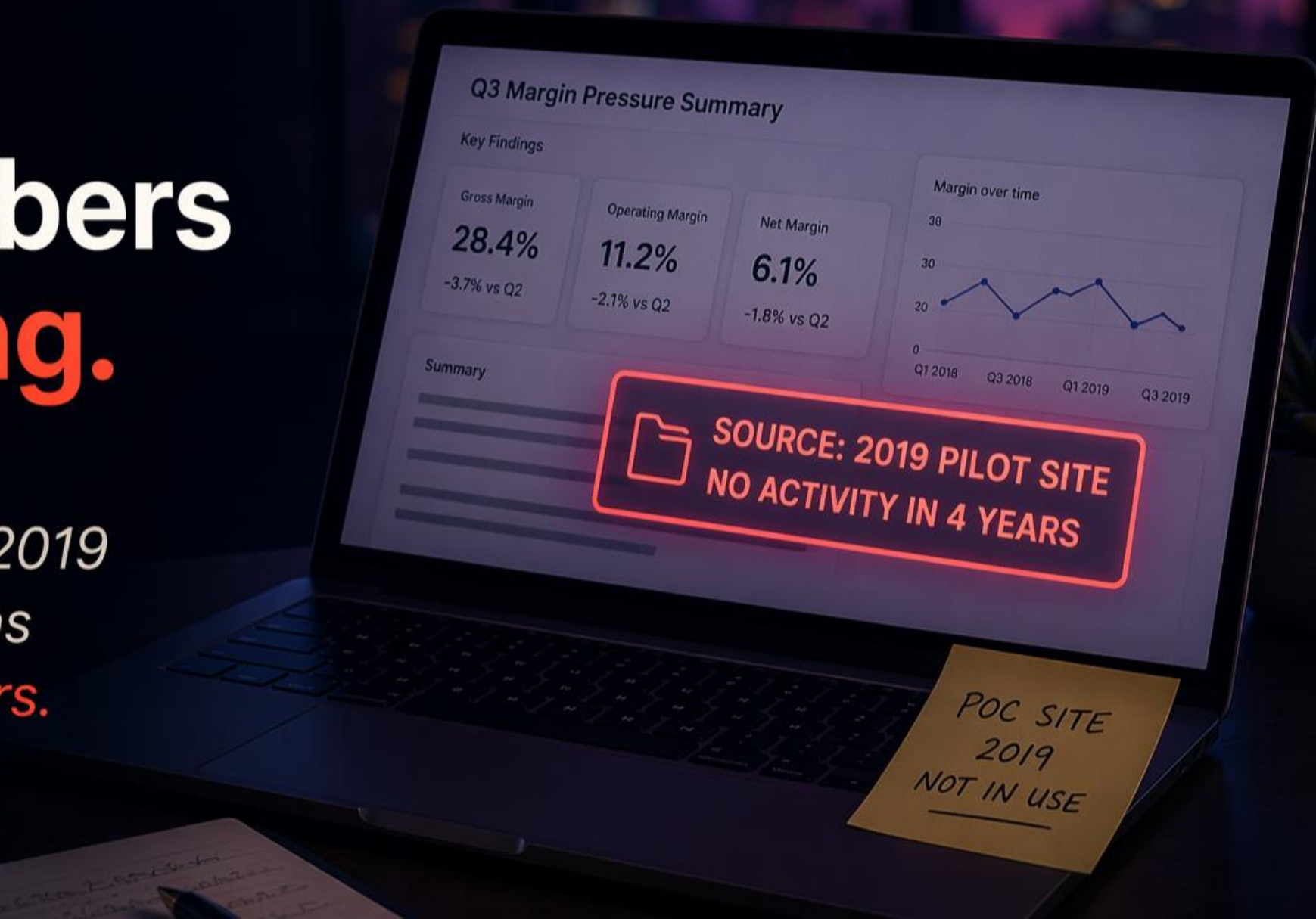
— *the prompt*





The numbers are wrong.

They came from a 2019
pilot site no-one has
opened in **four years**.



Copilot doesn't
create **data risk**



It
exposes it.

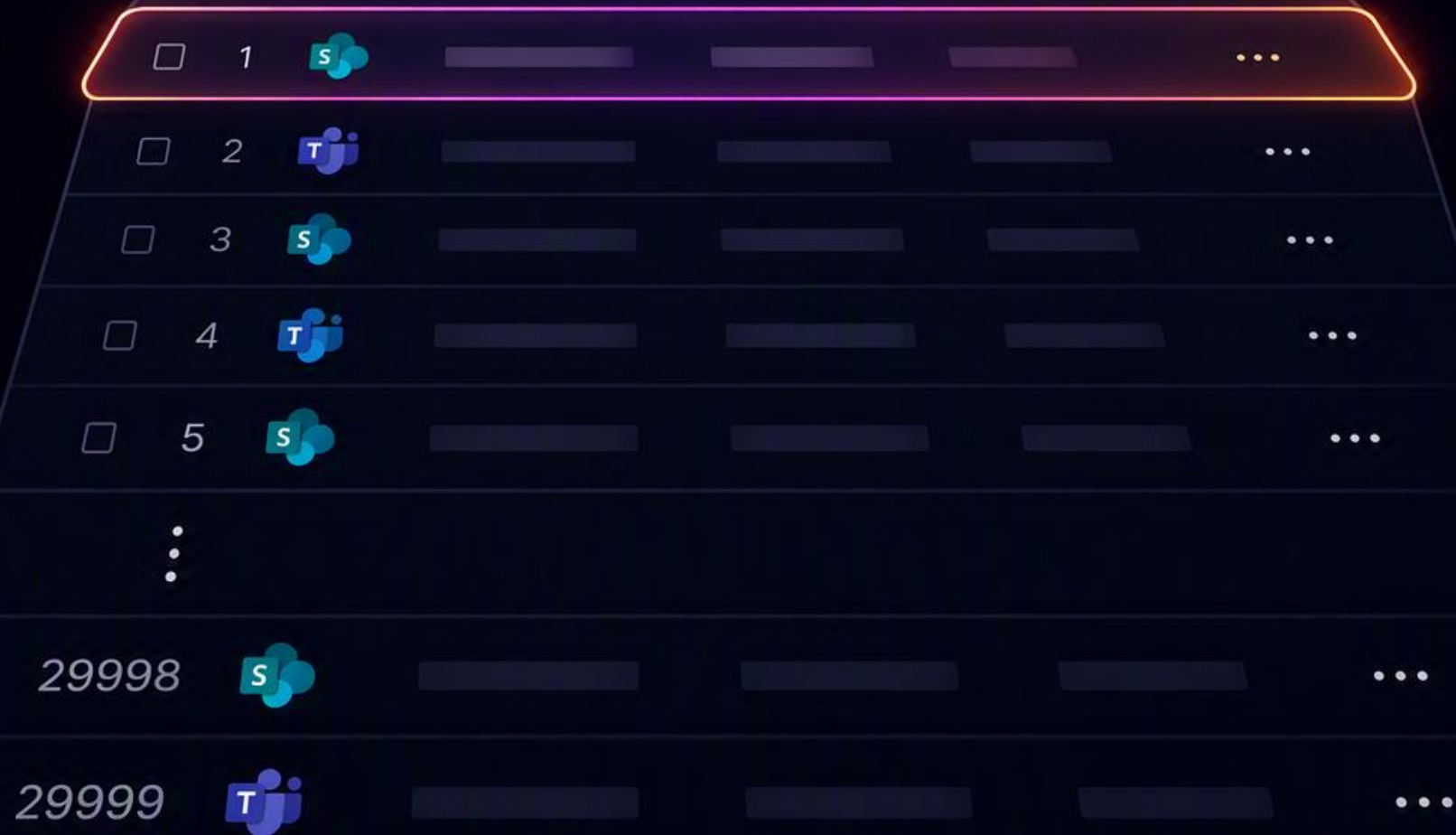


Your workspaces
were never
designed
for AI.



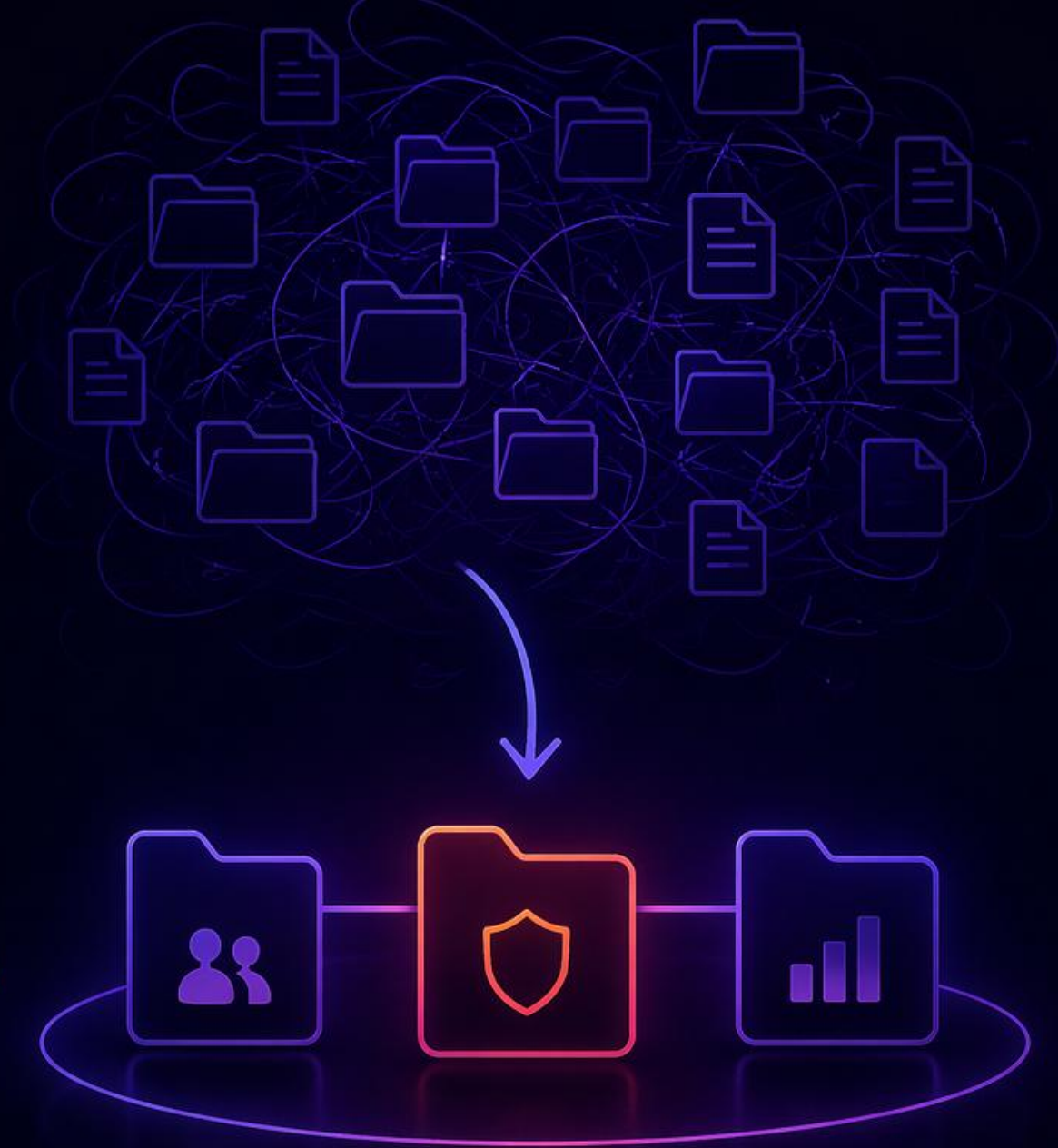
30,000 workspaces

A queue.
Not a plan.



You don't need
to fix everything.

Design
what matters.



Every workspace follows the same lifecycle



Workspaces are not equal



Treat each workspace based on its **value** and **risk**.

Three container controls that matter

Control

Purpose

Sensitivity Label



Sets defaults

RAC



Restricts audience

RCD



Restricts discoverability

PATTERN 1

Operational

Built for everyday collaboration.



Project sites



Team channels



Internal wikis



Open-by-design



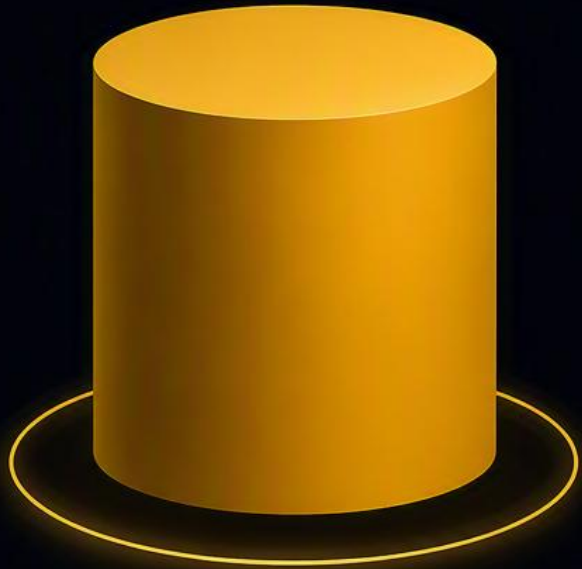
CONTROL

Container sensitivity labels

Default for the majority. Let labels do the work.

PATTERN 2

Sensitive



Protect what matters.



Private



Controlled



Restricted



Limited
discovery



CONTROL

Sensitivity label + RAC

Restrict access and limit sharing.

PATTERN 3

Locked Rooms

Highest sensitivity.



Invite only



Membership
controlled

Minimal access



Hidden from
search

Limited
discoverability



Strict controls

Highest governance
requirements



CONTROL

Sensitivity label + RAC + RCD

Limit access and discoverability.

PATTERN 4

Ghost sites

Inactive, historical content that no longer supports active work.



Unused Teams



Abandoned Projects



Former Departments



Legacy Collaboration



CONTROL

Archive or Delete

Reduce oversharing while maintaining compliance and retention obligations.

Four patterns. Four controls.

Match the control stack to the container intent.



Operational

Active collaboration

Control stack



Container label



Sensitive

Smaller audience

Control stack



Label



RAC



Locked Rooms

High-risk discovery

Control stack



Label



RAC



RCD



Ghost Sites

Inactive content

Control stack



Archive
or retire

Containers first. Files next.



Containers define
the **boundary**.



Files provide
the **evidence**.



Use evidence to make the **right container decision**.



Files next: finding the signals that matter



Copilot governance is **continuous**.



Prioritisation
focuses effort
where it matters most.



If Copilot
summarised this
site tomorrow...
Who would **object**?



Containers first. **Files** next.

Thank you.



Containers first, files next: a layered path to Copilot readiness